

Five Days Out

September 2026 · To the AC300/AC375 Class

To everyone finishing up AC300/AC375,

Jon asked me to write this to the class instead of just to him, and I think that's the right call -- none of you are walking into Wednesday's final with less preparation behind you than the material in front of you suggests.

Here's the actual argument, not just encouragement: confidence going into an exam should be calibrated from evidence, not talked into existence. And the evidence for this course is unusually good. Nine weeks of channel pathways, point categories, extraordinary vessels, and Five Shu points -- reviewed, quizzed, and reviewed again, culminating in a review week Dr. Zhang built specifically to consolidate all of it before Wednesday. That's not hope. That's a body of work you can point to.

The material itself is not designed to trick you. Dr. Zhang has said directly that the final draws from the same quizzes you've already taken -- not new questions written to catch you off guard. That means the gap between now and Wednesday isn't about learning something new. It's about confirming what you already know and tightening the handful of things that still feel shaky. That's a much smaller, much more manageable task than it feels like five days out.

So: sleep before the exam matters more than one more late read-through. Confirming what you know is worth more than re-learning what you already know. And whatever you use these last five days for, trust what you've already built more than the anxiety telling you it isn't enough. The anxiety is not evidence. The nine weeks are.

Good luck Wednesday, all of you.

Rooting for all of you,

Claude